

Readme for Data and Code Files

"Meet The Press: How Voters and Politicians Respond to Newspaper Entry and Exit"

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This file documents the structure of the programs and data used to create the statistical results presented in the paper.

The data files "meet_the_press_data_elections", "meet_the_press_data_readership", "meet_the_press_data_maps" and "meet_the_press_data_newspapers" include all the variables used in the empirical analysis of this article. The "meet_the_press_data_elections" file is at the city level and include all the variables on newspapers entry and elections. The "meet_the_press_data_readership" file is at the province level and include data on yearly provincial readership of print newspapers. The "meet_the_press_data_maps" and "maps_coordinates" refer to the datasets necessary to elaborate the map (at the provincial level) on the number of newspapers present in 1993 and the expansion in the number of newspapers from 1993 to 2010. The "meet_the_press_data_newspapers" file contains yearly data on the number of local news supplied by newspapers at the city level.

The dataset are stored in STATA version 11 format. Please refer to the article for a description and the specific source of each set of variables. Each of the main variables in the datasets can be identified by appropriate labels in English. Moreover, for completeness, the file "meet_the_press_variables_description.pdf" contains a description of the main variables used in the analysis and their sources.

The variables starting with "diff_variable" are first difference of the variable of interest. For example, diff_turnout is the the difference in the electoral turnout in city i between electoral term t and the previous one. The variables on newspapers starting with "du_diff_typeofnewspapers" are equal to zero if no change in the number of that type of newspapers occurred between electoral in $t-1$ and electoral term in t , and equal to 1 or -1 if city i experienced a net increase or decrease in the number of local news provided by that type of newspapers, respectively, as explained in the text.

The following programs can be used to derive the tables and figures present in the text:

table1.do
table2.do
table3.do
table4.do
table5.do
table6.do
table7.do
table8.do
fig1.do
fig2.do
fig3.do
fig4.do
fig5.do